

Asian Tech

Key takeaways from ARM Mar-quarter results takeaways

Key takeaways from ARM Mar-quarter earnings call for Asian Tech were:

- Confirming \$100bn+ CPU TAM by 2030:** ARM reiterated its view of an over US\$100bn CPU TAM by 2030, targeting 50% share. Management indicated that while GPUs have reached their reticle limit, CPU cores still have room to grow (from the current 136/88 cores in AGI CPU/Vera CPU to potentially 256 or even 512 cores for CPUs in the future). Meanwhile, the CPU-to-GPU ratio could rise beyond the current rack-level ratios with the introduction of dedicated CPU racks (e.g., NVIDIA's Vera rack). Given recent positive commentary on CPUs amid surging agentic AI demand, we expect this to further tighten the semiconductor supply chain— particularly TSMC for front-end wafers and ASE for packaging and testing.
- AGI CPU demand upside with pipeline reaching \$2bn, but supply chain tightness a swing factor:** Management sees AGI CPU demand upside to US \$2bn+ versus the current unchanged guidance of US\$1bn for FY27–28 (CY Apr 2026 to Apr 2028), with the client base potentially expanding beyond the current partner (Meta) to include OpenAI, Cerebras, Rebellions, Positron and others. First production for AGI CPU is scheduled for 1Q27. That said, management indicated that supply-chain tightness—spanning memory, wafers, packaging, and test equipment—needs to be resolved first to reach the beyond \$1bn level demand. We believe the supply chain tightness will persist into 2027, continuing to favor names like TSMC, ASE, SK Hynix, Samsung, and Advantest.
- Conservative tone on market smartphone demand:** Management indicated that overall market YoY unit growth turned negative in the March quarter and expects negative growth to persist into the June quarter. The tone on smartphones is relatively negative, even with ARM's less exposure to the mid-range to low-end segment. This is broadly consistent with recent market signals, with a 10%+ smartphone unit decline expected in 2026 (see [link](#)). In addition, we are concerned that demand could deteriorate further in 2H as recent end-product price hikes begin to weigh on sell-through. We remain cautious on smartphone-exposed names such as Xiaomi.

Arm Holdings (ARM US) is covered by JPM US analyst Harlan Sur.

Technology and Telecoms

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